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VIKRAM DAMODARAN

CHIEF INNOVATION OFFICER,
DIAGEO INDIA

flavour blocks of whiskey, with choices ranging from sweet and creamy to those with a hint of sourness and a bitter aftertaste.

“The biggest difference that we offer to clients is that, firstly, we don’t see it as an investment project. Second, we clearly offer it as a custom-designed liquid from the get-go. This essentially also stands as an opportunity for us to present a cask programme from India that’s elevated and yet distinct and different from everything else that’s available today globally,” says Damodaran.

THE INDIA RARE Spirits cask programme does have an edge as it rides on the coattails of Diageo’s global Casks of Distinction programme and has access to its already present crème de la crème roster of clients. The entry level for the programme starts at about ₹30 lakh for a cask, and it goes up depending on the complexity of finishing, the age of the liquid, and customisations. In India, the highest-value cask they have delivered to date has been worth ₹75 lakh.

Takers for such bespoke programmes are limited but they are true connoisseurs. For first-time participants, master distillers provide close guidance, walking them through each stage as their chosen spirit matures over the years into a one-of-a-kind expression.

The allure lies in exclusivity, attracting ultra-high-net-worth and high-net-worth collectors, discerning connoisseurs, investors, and whiskey clubs. Enthusiasts and luxury hotels, groups celebrating milestones, investors, and bottlers form another demand group. M&P Pavlina marked its silver jubilee by commissioning Paul John for a rare



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Maturation

TROPICAL AGEING
IN INDIA ACCELERATES
DEVELOPMENT

6

Personalisation

CLIENTS TAILOR FLAVOUR,
FINISH, BOTTLE DESIGN,
AND LABELS

7

Bottling & Branding

FINALISED EXPRESSION
BOTTLED, OFTEN
NUMBERED AND EXCLUSIVE
TO THE BUYER



7

Delivery & Legacy

A COLLECTOR’S
TREASURE THAT IS UNIQUE,
INIMITABLE